



Context Course documentation

Quiz 1: MCP Fundamentals ▾



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Test your understanding of MCP architecture and core concepts. Choose the best answer for each question.

Question 1: The M×N Integration Problem

- ☒ Without MCP, you need M agents × N tools separate integrations

Correct! Correct! This is the integration complexity MCP solves. With MCP, you build N servers once, and any agent can use them.

- ☐ Agents can only integrate with one tool at a time
- ☐ MCP requires a different implementation for every agent
- ☐ Modern APIs eliminate the need for MCP

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You got all the answers!

Question 2: Hosts, Clients, and Servers

- ☒ Host runs the agent, Client requests capabilities, Server provides them

Correct! Perfect! The Host is the agent's environment (Claude Code, Codex, OpenCode). The Client is the protocol handler requesting from servers. The Server exposes capabilities.

- ☐ Server runs the agent, Client provides data, Host makes requests
- ☐ Client runs the agent, Server requests capabilities, Host provides them
- ☐ All three are interchangeable roles

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You got all the answers!

Question 3: Tools vs. Resources vs. Prompts

- ☒ Tools: callable functions | Resources: read-only data | Prompts: instruction templates

Correct! Exactly! Tools perform actions or queries. Resources provide static data. Prompts guide agent behavior.

- ☐ Tools: static data | Resources: callable functions | Prompts: configurations
- ☐ All three are the same capability type
- ☐ Resources and Prompts don't exist in modern MCP

You got all the answers!

Question 4: MCP Transport Mechanisms

- ☒ Stdio for local servers, Streamable HTTP for remote servers

Correct! Correct! Stdio uses subprocess communication (fast, simple, local). Streamable HTTP is the current standard for remote connections, replacing the older HTTP+SSE transport.

- ☐ HTTP+SSE is the only remote transport option
- ☐ Always use Streamable HTTP—it's more powerful
- ☐ Transport is irrelevant; MCP hides it from agents

You got all the answers!

Question 5: Skills vs. MCP

- ☒ Skills: static context. MCP: dynamic, real-time access to tools and data

Correct! Perfect! Skills are pre-written and bundled. MCP servers provide live access that changes without agent restart.

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- MCP is just a newer name for Skills
- MCP is only for APIs; Skills are for everything else
- You have to choose between Skills and MCP

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You got all the answers!

Summary

How did you do? If you got 4-5 questions correct, you have a solid grasp of MCP fundamentals. If you struggled, review “Key Concepts and Architecture” before moving to the next section.

Key concepts to remember:

- **MCP solves the M×N problem** with universal server standard
- **Three roles:** Host (agent location), Client (protocol handler), Server (capability provider)
- **Three capabilities:** Tools (callable), Resources (data), Prompts (instructions)
- **Two transports:** Stdio (local development), Streamable HTTP (remote/production)
- **Skills + MCP work together** to teach and enable agent capabilities

</> [Update](#) on GitHub

← Building MCP Servers with Python

Configuring Agents as MCP Clients →



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